I'm a docket clerk at the tax court, general responsibilities i feel like we do everything.

We basically make sure that whatever's filed by the petitioner or respondent that it's filed correctly and if it's not filed correctly that we correct it.

We also process orders from the ADC, from the judge's chambers, and from the petitions department.

This is actually a small consolidated case, just two docket numbers together here. One of my coworkers has 20 cases attached to the consolidation. If we're processing an order we have to process it separately in each case. Whereas before we just processed it once and it was automatically put in all of the cases. Now imagine her with those 20 cases having to go into each case and process each order. But also imagine too if a document comes in in all of those cases and something is wrong with one of them in one of the cases. It's a little bit frustrating trying to straighten things out especially when there's a lot of cases but even when there's two it can be frustrating too. I think hers was the largest number that i've seen in a while. There are some that are 15 or maybe 10, but i feel like hers was like over 20, that was a lot but I haven't seen anyone who had more than that.

If it was straightforward, it would just be like processing it in a regular case [so just a couple minutes] if even that, within the order.

If i was processing something in this case I would get the order. I would go to wherever the order is, process it, make sure it's done correctly in the lead case, then i would go over to the other case, process it there, make sure that's done and I would respond back in the lead case and let them know this order has been processed in this case as well as the related case and just send it back to the judge letting them know it was processed.

[Processed] That just means that I'm serving the order and doing whatever needs to be done. Sometimes a motion will be acted on, so that means that I would have to go beside the motion... So if this was a motion right here,I would have to click here [action column] and add the ORD and the date and I would have to do that in all of the cases physically. Whereas usually when something is consolidated you just do it in that lead case and it's done in all of them.

[how often encounter consolidated cases] It's daily, there's a number of consolidated cases so it's something we deal with on a daily basis. If it's not us processing an order that came from ADC or from a Judge's Chambers, it's us processing QC that comes in on all of the cases and having to make sure that everything is done correctly in each case before you send it up to the Judge or ADC.

I would say maybe in a day, a few times a day, I don't know if i can put a number on it because it depends on what's coming in and what the judge is putting out.

[for consolidated cases] I wait until I have enough time to do it depending on how many cases are in the consolidation because it takes time. You have to go through and make sure things are correct.

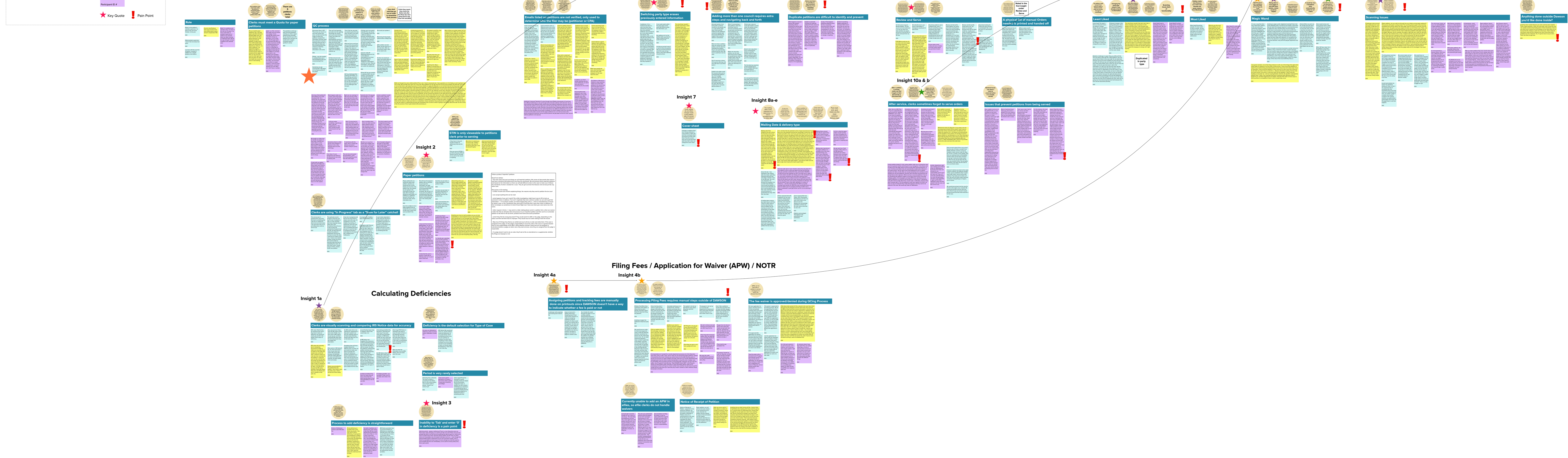
The respondents and petitioners they now understand they have to file things in each case whereas before they didn't have to so that's a little frustrating. But when they file stuff it has to be filed in each case and if you see something that's not right you have to jot that down and then continue to go through the rest of the cases and then after all of it's QC'd then you send it up to the judge and you have to add a note that 'hey in this particular case, this was incorrect, how do you wish for this to be handled?' so it just leaves a lot of opportunities for mistakes.

I put it off [consolidated cases] just until I have a little bit more time to deal with it.

Sometimes if I'm dealing with a really large consolidated case, I'll wait until the end of the day to give myself time to really go through it because if not I'll rush through it and then I'll make a mistake. So i just want to have more than enough time to make sure my eyes are on everything so that they don't come back and say hey you guys didn't see this...I have to give myself more time or i'll get frustrated.

Understanding Petition QC - USTC

UX Team - Petition's Clerk Interviews Research Synthesis



KEY

- ● Participant 002
- ● Participant 003
- ● Participant 004

Insight

Research Team Internal Note, Question or Comment

Theme

Data point Participant ID #

★ Key Quote

! Pain Point

Background

Role

Clerks must meet a Quota for paper petitions

There are 5 petitions clerks total.

Process

QC process

STIN is only viewable to petitions clerk prior to serving

Insight 2

Paper petitions

Clerks are using "In Progress" tab as a "Save for Later" catchall

Emails

Emails listed on petitions are not verified, only used to determine who the filer may be (petitioner or CPA)

Insight 5a & b

Switching party type erases previously entered information

UI Pain Points

Insight 6

Adding more than one council requires extra steps and navigating back and forth

Duplicate petitions are difficult to identify and prevent

Insight 7

Cover sheet

Insight 8a-e

Mailing Date & delivery type

Serving petitions and issuing orders

Insight 9a & b

Review and Serve

Noted in the first insight under Review and Serve

A physical list of manual Orders needed is printed and handed off

Insight 10a & b

After service, clerks sometimes forget to serve orders

Issues that prevent petitions from being served

Overall Impression

Insight 1b

Least Liked

Duplicated in party type

Most Liked

Insight 4c

Insight 11a

Magic Wand

Insight 10c

Pain Points Outside of DAWSON

Insight 11b & c

Scanning Issues

Anything done outside Dawson you'd like done inside?

Calculating Deficiencies

Insight 1a

Clerks are visually scanning and comparing IRS Notice data for accuracy

Deficiency is the default selection for Type of Case

Period is very rarely selected

Insight 3

Process to add deficiency is straightforward

Inability to 'Tab' and enter '0' in deficiency is a pain point

Filing Fees / Application for Waiver (APW) / NOTR

Insight 4a

Assigning petitions and tracking fees are manually done on printouts since DAWSON doesn't have a way to indicate whether a fee is paid or not

Insight 4b

Processing Filing Fees requires manual steps outside of DAWSON

The fee waiver is approved/denied during QCing Process

Currently unable to add an APW in efiles, so efile clerks do not handle waivers

Notice of Receipt of Petition